

HR Digital Transformation: Design Thinking Case Study

Introduction

This document presents a structured application of the Design Thinking methodology to address a decline in employee psychological capital and productivity resulting from the sudden implementation of an AI performance management system.

Phase 1: Empathize

Objective

To deeply understand the employees' psychological and practical struggles regarding the new AI system.

Outcome: Empathy Map

Quadrant	User Expressions & Behaviors
Say	"This challenge might make me lose my job.", "I cannot adapt; we need alternative solutions."
Do	Avoids AI-related tasks, procrastinates, fails to meet required standards.
Think	Considers resigning, looking for another job, or transferring to a non-digital department.
Feel	Frustrated, helpless, and overwhelmed by the technological shift.

Phase 2: Define

Objective

To accurately frame the root problem using the Lotus Blossom tool, separating symptoms from causes.

Outcome: Problem Definition and Root Causes

Central Problem: A decline in performance and job burnout due to the sudden implementation of an AI system without proper preparation.

8 Root Causes (Lotus Petals):

1. Lack of institutional preparation for the transition.
2. Ignoring psychological preparation and resilience-building for employees.
3. Absence of specialized training workshops.
4. Lack of employee consultation and empowerment (absence of Kaizen).
5. Complexity of the AI system's interface (poor UX).
6. Absence of immediate and transparent feedback channels.
7. Fear of losing job security to algorithms.
8. Ignoring individual differences in technical learning speeds.

Phase 3: Ideate

Objective

To brainstorm solutions that humanize the digital workspace and rebuild psychological capital.

Outcome: Phased Strategy

- **Pre-Implementation:** Launch educational newsletters and micro-diplomas with incentives to build foundational knowledge.
- **During Implementation:** Re-apply empathy to gather feedback. Design adaptive programs for varying skill levels and reward early adopters.
- **Post-Implementation:** Establish a dedicated peer-support unit consisting of tech-savvy employees with reduced secondary duties.

Phase 4: Prototype

Objective

To build fast, low-cost representations of the proposed solutions for testing.

Outcome: Three Prototypes

- **Educational Booklet:** A simple guide explaining AI integration and interaction.
- **Interactive Mockup:** A front-end, no-database simulation of the training platform to test user flow.
- **Voice-Enabled Chatbot:** An AI assistant designed with voice accessibility to support employees, ensuring the organization meets the 5% inclusion quota for people of determination.

Phase 5: Test

Objective

To evaluate the prototypes using observation and interviews, discovering friction points.

Outcome: Testing Insights and Iteration

Discovery: Testing the chatbot revealed a deeper issue—basic computer illiteracy among a segment of the workforce.

Iterative Action: The HR strategy was adjusted to mandate basic IT literacy training prior to AI onboarding, and recruitment policies were updated to require baseline technical skills. This structural change bridges the gap between traditional operations and digital readiness.